

README – n8n Workflow

APIs Used & Why

- **GitHub REST API** (first request)
Endpoint: GET https://api.github.com/search/repositories?q=topic:nodejs&sort=stars&per_page=10
Why: Fetches the most popular Node.js repositories sorted by stars. This gives us a relevant, high-quality data source for a daily “morning brief”.
- **GitHub README API** (second request / enrichment)
Endpoint: GET https://api.github.com/repos/{full_name}/readme
Why: Enriches the top repositories (those with >1000 stars) by retrieving their README. This adds context and value to the digest.

Transformation

After fetching the list of repositories, a **Code node** (Extract Top 5 Repos) performs the following:

- Sorts all returned repositories by `stargazers_count` in descending order.
- Keeps only the **top 5** repositories.
- Extracts and reshapes the data to a clean object containing: `full_name`, `stars`, `description`, `url`, `owner`.

This ensures the workflow outputs a concise, relevant digest without overwhelming the notification channel.

Conditional Branching

An **IF node** (Check Stars > 1000) splits the top 5 repos:

- **True branch** (stars > 1000): The repo is considered “highly popular”. The workflow enriches it by calling the README API (second HTTP request).
- **False branch** (stars ≤ 1000): The repo is not enriched; it simply continues to the final output (or a NoOp node). This reduces unnecessary API calls.

Error Path Behaviour

The workflow implements robust error handling to **never crash silently**:

- **Continue On Fail** is enabled on both HTTP Request nodes (Fetch GitHub Repos and Fetch README).
- If Fetch GitHub Repos fails (e.g., network error, rate limit, invalid URL), the **error output** is routed directly to an Error Notification node.
- The Error Notification node sends a detailed alert to the same Discord webhook, including the error message and timestamp.
- If Fetch README fails for a specific repo (e.g., no README file), the error output is **also sent to the same error notification** without breaking the rest of the workflow.
- The Error Notification node uses a POST request to Discord with a message like:
 Workflow failed: <error details>

Because of this design, the workflow never stops unexpectedly – administrators are always notified of API failures.

Output

The final digest is sent to a **Discord webhook** (the same channel used for error notifications). The message includes the top 5 Node.js repositories with their names, star counts, descriptions, and URLs. Optionally, the README content can be included, but the assignment only requires the enrichment call – which is already performed.